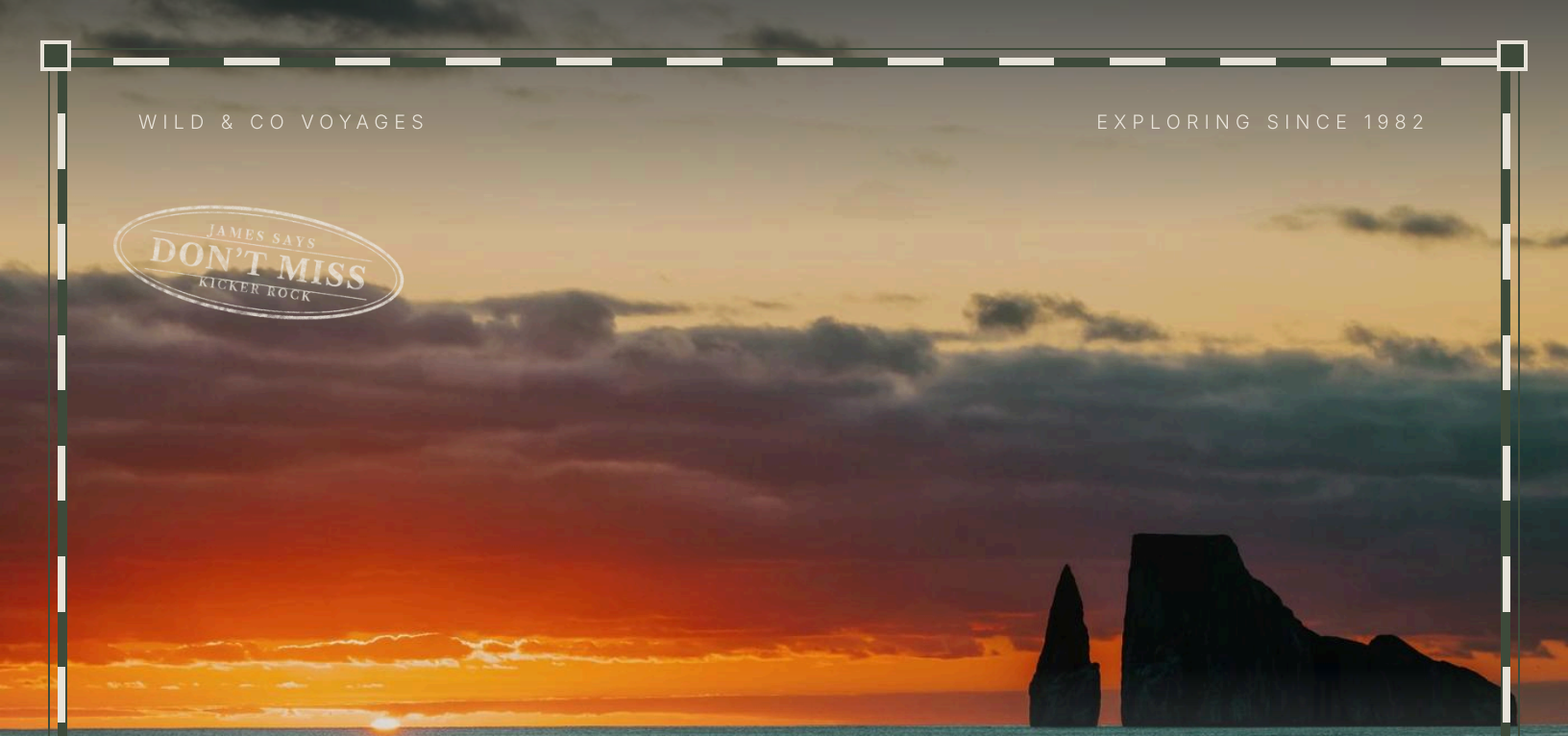


JAMES WILD & CO.

LEDGERED & VETTED

JOURNEY DESIGN SINCE 1982

JAMES WILD & CO.

GALÁPAGOS

THE ISLANDS, IN FOUR PAGES

When to go, sea or land, six islands worth the crossing and who you'll meet on them. Read it over one coffee.

"Five days is a trailer. You came for the film."

— JAMES WILD, CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER

JAMES WILD & CO.
I KEEP GOING BACK
GALÁPAGOS · SINCE 1991

THE QUICK GUIDE
FIELD GUIDE NO. 01

START HERE
MEET IGGI

COVER: KICKER ROCK, SAN CRISTÓBAL
PHOTO: ECOVENTURA



HI, I'M IGGI · JAMES'S TRIP-BUILDING BUDDY

Circle what makes you grin, then find **Iggi's Compass** on the Galápagos page at jameswildco.com. Tell me your month and your crew; the voyage takes shape before your coffee's cold. *Never lost. Only scenic.*

01 · WHEN TO GO — PLAN · 02 / 04

Warm or wowed, pick your season

December to May for warm water and calm seas; June to November for the cool garúa season and the liveliest wildlife. There's no bad month.

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Season	warm	warm	warm	warm	warm	garúa	garúa	garúa	garúa	garúa	garúa	warm
Sea, approx.	24–26°	24–26°	24–26°	24–26°	24–26°	19–22°	19–22°	19–22°	19–22°	19–22°	19–22°	24–26°
Albatross, Española	·	·	·	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
Best for	snorkel	snorkel	snorkel	snorkel	snorkel	wildlife	wildlife	wildlife	wildlife	wildlife	wildlife	snorkel

02 · WHO IT'S FOR — PLAN

IF YOU'RE…	GO	OUR PICK
First-timers	Any month	The Contrast · Pikaia, then Cruise C
Families, kids 8 and up	Dec–May	Pikaia by land, or the whole yacht
Couples & honeymooners	Dec–May	Sea Star balcony suite, Cruise A
Snorkelers & divers	Dec–May	Cruise C · the young west
Photographers	Jun–Nov	Española & Genovesa
Solo travelers	Any month	Sea Star · ask about single rates

> *Give the islands enough days to tell the story in order. Five days is a trailer.*
> — J. WILD

Six islands, oldest to youngest

The islands are born in the west and carried east. Read them in that order, and everything makes sense.

THE LEDGER
I'VE WALKED IT
VETTED ON FOOT



Española
● I'VE WALKED IT

The elder: waved albatross (about Apr–Dec), the Suárez blowhole.

Genovesa
● I'VE WALKED IT

The bird island: red-footed boobies, frigatebirds, owls.

Isabela & Fernandina
● I'VE WALKED IT

The young west: iguanas, cormorants, penguins on the equator.

Floreana
● I'VE WALKED IT

Flamingos, Devil's Crown snorkelling, the Post Office Bay barrel.

Santiago & Bartolomé
● I'VE WALKED IT

Pinnacle Rock from the summit, fresh lava at Sullivan Bay.

Santa Cruz
● I'LL KNOW SOON

Wild tortoises in the cloud forest, and Pikaia Lodge.



Penguins on the equator PHOTO: ECOVENTURA



The dance is real PHOTO: PIKAIA LODGE



The slowest schedule PHOTO: PIKAIA LODGE

The rest, in short



ROYAL GALAPAGOS

BY SEA

Oldest to Youngest

Galapagos Sea Star, 16 guests. Cruise A, B or C, or all three: the Full Circle.

● I KNOW WHO KNOWS



PIKAIA LODGE

BY LAND

Highlands & Day Boats

Pikaia Lodge, 14 rooms on the volcano, islands by the lodge's own yacht.

● I'LL KNOW SOON



ROYAL GALAPAGOS

BOTH

The Contrast

Three nights at Pikaia, then Cruise C west to Isabela and Fernandina. Nine days.

● I KEEP GOING BACK · THE JAMES WILD WAY

FOUR RULES OF THE ROAD

The smaller the boat, the bigger the sea · Old islands first · Arrive the day before the day before · Land, then sea



JAMES WILD & CO.
LEDGERED & VETTED
JOURNEY DESIGN SINCE 1982

READY? FOLLOW MY TAIL

Tell Iggi warm or wowed.

James takes it from there.

Tap Iggi's Compass at jameswildco.com/voyages/galapagos, or text James on 561.479.6355. Want the long version? Ask for the 19-page field guide.

Already have a travel advisor? We're happy to work with them. Seasons, fees and wildlife timing are guidance only; the Park has the final word. Photographs: Ecoventura (Brooke Pyke), Pikaia Lodge, Royal Galapagos, used with permission. Map from Natural Earth data. FL Seller of Travel ST45327 · IATAN 10783883 · Exploring Since 1982. © 2026 James Wild & Co.